

Future Society: Trends & Outlook

未来社会发展趋势探讨

Date: 2026-06-08 | Lesson 12 | Level: B1-B2

English Class Course Material

Learning Goals

学习目标

- Discuss how AI is reshaping the job market and identify roles at risk

讨论 AI 如何重塑就业市场，识别高风险职业

- Compare traditional vs emerging status symbols in modern society

比较传统身份象征与新兴身份象征

- Analyze the housing crisis and intergenerational conflicts

分析房价危机与代际矛盾

- Explain the link between marriage, fertility rate, and labor supply

解释婚恋、生育率与劳动力供给的关系

- Balance individualism and collectivism in social discussion

在社会话题中把握个人主义与集体主义的平衡

- Use new vocabulary (lifespan, VR, cloning, etc.) in structured speech

在新话题中运用 lifespan / VR / cloning 等词汇

- Apply grammar correction strategies from classroom examples

运用课堂示例的语法纠错策略

Warm-up Questions

课前讨论

1. Which jobs do you think will disappear in the next 10 years?

你认为未来 10 年哪些职业会消失？

2. What is a typical status symbol in your social circle?

在你身边，什么是典型的身份象征？

3. Do you think housing prices will go up or down in the future?

你认为未来房价会涨还是会跌？

4. Is the birth rate a problem in your country? Why?

生育率在你所在国家是问题吗？为什么？

5. How do you balance personal freedom and group interests?

你如何平衡个人自由与集体利益？

Key Vocabulary

核心词汇

Word	Pron.	POS	Chinese	Example
repetitive	/rɪˈpetətɪv/	adj.	重复性的	Translation is a repetitive job.
competitive	/kəmˈpetətɪv/	adj.	竞争激烈的	Driver jobs will become more competitive.
translation	/trænzˈleɪʃn/	n.	翻译	AI is replacing human translation.
driver	/ˈdraɪvə(r)/	n.	司机	Personal drivers may become a luxury.
service	/ˈsɜːvɪs/	n.	服务	Customer service is highly automated now.
influencer	/ˈɪnfluənsə(r)/	n.	网红/博主	She is a top fashion influencer.
go in debt	/gəʊ ɪn det/	v. phr.	负债	He went in debt to buy a luxury car.
rent	/rent/	v.	短期租用	Some people rent designer bags to post photos.
status symbol	ˈstetəs ˈsɪmbəl	n.	身份象征	A house used to be a clear status symbol.
materialistic	/məˈtɪəriəˈlɪstɪk/	adj.	物质至上的	A materialistic lifestyle creates pressure.
housing price	ˈhaʊzɪŋ praɪs/	n.	房价	Housing prices in big cities keep rising.
resource	/rɪˈsɔːs/	n.	资源	Housing is a limited resource.
generation	/ˌdʒenəˈreɪʃn/	n.	一代人	Each generation has different values.
baby boomer	ˈbeɪbi ˈbuːmə(r)	n.	婴儿潮一代	Baby boomers often own multiple houses.
misunderstanding	ˌmɪsʌndeɪˈstændɪŋ/	n.	误解	There is a generation misunderstanding.
marriage	/ˈmærɪdʒ/	n.	婚姻	Many parents urge early marriage.
fertility rate	/fəˈtɪləti reɪt/	n.	生育率	The fertility rate is dropping globally.
labor force	/ˈleɪbə fɔːs/	n.	劳动力	Low birth rate shrinks the labor force.
free time	/friː taɪm/	n.	闲暇时间	More free time may raise birth willingness.
individualism	ˌɪndɪˈvɪdʒuəlɪzəm/	n.	个人主义	Individualism values personal freedom.
collectivism	/kəˈlektɪvɪzəm/	n.	集体主义	Collectivism values group interests.
creativity	/ˌkriːəˈtɪvəti/	n.	创造力	Too much collectivism can kill creativity.

sweet spot	/swi:t spot/	n.	甜蜜点	We need a sweet spot between rules and freedom.
conflict	/'konflikt/	n.	冲突	Extreme views often lead to conflict.
lifespan	/'laɪfspæn/	n.	寿命	Modern medicine extends human lifespan.
medical development	/'medɪkl dɪ'veləpmənt/	n.	医疗进步	Medical development reduces infant death.
healthy habit	/'helθi 'hæbɪt/	n.	健康习惯	Healthy habits add years to life.
resource allocation	/'reɪsɪs ,ælə'keɪʃn/	n.	资源分配	An aging society tests resource allocation.
virtual reality (VR)	/'tʃuəl ri'æləti/	n.	虚拟现实	VR could be the next social platform.
animal protection	/'ænɪml prə'tekʃn/	n.	动物保护	Animal protection laws are getting stricter.
clone	/kləʊn/	v.	克隆	Human cloning is heavily debated.
privacy	/'prɪvəsi/	n.	隐私	Digital privacy is a major concern.
labor law	/'leɪbə lɔ:/	n.	劳动法	Labor laws limit overwork in some countries.
illegal	/ɪ'li:gl/	adj.	非法的	Human cloning is currently illegal in many places.
star traveling	/'stɑ: 'trævəlɪŋ/	n.	星际旅行	Star traveling may become a reality.
pollution	/pə'lu:ʃn/	n.	污染	Industrial development causes pollution.
energy	/'enədʒi/	n.	能源	Clean energy is the key to sustainability.
nuclear power	/'nju:klɪə 'paʊə(r)/	n.	核能	Nuclear power is clean but risky.
eco-protection	/'i:kəʊ prə'tekʃn/	n.	环保	Eco-protection is a global responsibility.
romantic relationship	/'rɒmɒntɪk rɪ'leɪʃnʃɪp/	n.	恋爱关系	AI romantic relationships are emerging.
challenge	/'tʃælɪndʒ/	n.	挑战	Life without challenges feels empty.
art	/ɑ:t/	n.	艺术	Foreign languages may become a form of art.

Useful Expressions

实用表达

1. Talking about AI and Jobs

谈论 AI 与就业

Use this structure: 'AI + verb' to describe automation. Pair with 'be replaced by' for risk and 'be upgraded' for new high-end roles.

用 'AI + 动词' 描述自动化；用 'be replaced by' 表达被替代，用 'be upgraded' 表达升级。

A:

Translation and driving are easy to be replaced by AI.

翻译和驾驶很容易被 AI 替代。

B:

Right, but personal drivers may be upgraded into a luxury service.

没错，但私人司机可能升级为奢侈服务。

► AI replaces repetitive jobs; humans shift to high-end, personalized, status-symbol roles.

2. Describing Modern Status Symbols

描述当代身份象征

Traditional symbols: watches / cars / houses. Emerging: influencers / rented luxury / digital status.

传统象征：名表 / 豪车 / 房产。新兴象征：网红 / 租来的奢侈品 / 数字身份。

A:

Some young people go in debt just to look wealthy.

一些年轻人为了显得富有而负债。

B:

It's a materialistic trap. We should value substance over image.

这是物质主义的陷阱。我们应该更看重实质而不是形象。

► rent designer items / post photos online / pretend to be wealthy —
表达'营造人设'的地道搭配。

3. Discussing Housing and Generations

讨论房价与代际

Use 'limited resource' to explain prices. Use 'misunderstanding' to describe the gap between generations.

用 'limited resource' 解释价格；用 'misunderstanding' 描述代际差距。

A:

Housing is a limited resource, so prices keep rising.

住房是稀缺资源，所以价格不断上涨。

B:

Yes, and Gen Z often has misunderstandings with baby boomers about life pressure.

是的，而且 Z 世代和婴儿潮一代对生活压力常有误解。

► fierce competition / life pressure / job market — 描述社会压力的高频搭配。

4. Talking about Marriage and Fertility

谈论婚恋与生育

Describe the chain: low fertility -> labor shortage -> pension pressure. Use 'urge' for parents pushing marriage.

描述链条：低生育率 -> 劳动力短缺 -> 养老压力。用 'urge' 表达长辈催婚。

A:

Many parents urge their children to get married early.

很多父母催孩子早点结婚。

B:

To raise the fertility rate, we need more free time and lower living costs.

要提高生育率，需要更多闲暇时间和更低的生活成本。

► matchmaking corner / labor force shortage / pension burden — 描述人口议题的高频搭配。

5. Balancing Individualism and Collectivism

平衡个人与集体

Use 'too much X kills Y' to describe extremes. Use 'sweet spot' to suggest balance.

用 'too much X kills Y' 描述极端；用 'sweet spot' 表达平衡。

A:

Too much individualism causes conflict.

过多的个人主义会导致冲突。

B:

And too much collectivism kills creativity. We need a sweet spot.

而太多的集体主义会扼杀创造力。我们需要平衡点。

► rules and freedom / group goals vs personal goals — 平衡议题的常用对比。

6. Talking about Lifespan and Ethics

谈论寿命与伦理

Use 'extend lifespan' for medicine. Use 'digital immortality' / 'copy is not the real self' for ethics.

用 'extend lifespan' 描述医学进步；用 'digital immortality' 和 'copy is not the real self' 讨论伦理。

A:

Some scientists believe we can copy human brains into computers.

一些科学家认为我们可以把大脑复制到计算机中。

B:

But most people think the copy is not the real self.

但大多数人认为复制体不是真正的自己。

► aging society / pension system / resource allocation — 老龄化议题高频搭配。

7. Discussing Future Laws

讨论未来法律

Use 'heated debates' to describe controversial topics like cloning. Use 'work-life balance' for labor reforms.

用 'heated debates' 描述克隆等争议话题；用 'work-life balance' 描述劳动改革。

A:

There are heated debates on human cloning.

围绕人类克隆有激烈争论。

B:

Labor laws will also be improved to prevent overwork.

劳动法也会改进以防止过度加班。

► data privacy / phone-use rules / digital ethics — 未来规则的常见议题。

8. Talking about Tech, Energy and Space

谈论科技、能源与太空

Use 'balance development and safety' for energy. Use 'huge resources' for space travel.

用 'balance development and safety' 描述能源取舍；用 'huge resources' 描述太空旅行。

A:

Star traveling may come true, but it costs huge resources.

星际旅行可能成真，但需要巨大资源。

B:

Nuclear power is clean and powerful, yet risky. We need to balance development and safety.

核能清洁高效但有风险。我们要在发展与安全之间取得平衡。

► renewable energy / carbon emissions / space exploration — 科技与环境高频搭配。

9. Discussing AI Romance and Language Learning

讨论 AI 恋爱与外语学习

Use 'without challenges' to describe AI romance. Use 'form of art' to describe future language learning.

用 'without challenges' 描述 AI 恋爱；用 'form of art' 描述未来语言学习。

A:

AI always satisfies you, but life without challenges cannot bring real happiness.

AI 总是满足你，但没有挑战的生活无法带来真正的幸福。

B:

Learning foreign languages will become a status symbol, like a form of art.

学外语会变成身份象征，像一种艺术。

► empathy / creativity / critical thinking — AI 时代人类核心能力。

Dialogue / Reading

对话与阅读

Topic 1: AI's Impact on Jobs

话题 1：AI 对就业的影响

Repetitive jobs are replaced first; some jobs shift to high-end, status-symbol roles.

重复性工作最先被替代；部分岗位升级为高端、身份象征型职业。

Teacher:

What jobs vanish first with AI?

哪些工作最先因 AI 消失？

Student:

Repetitive ones—AI never tires, so translation, driving, and customer service are easily replaced.

重复性的——AI 不知疲倦，所以翻译、驾驶和客服都容易被替代。

Teacher:

Yet, personal drivers and translators become rare, high-end roles. Wealthy people choose humans as a status symbol.

但私人司机和翻译会变成稀缺的高端岗位。富人把真人服务当作身份象征。

Student:

So the same job becomes more competitive, but the pay rises?

所以同样的岗位竞争更激烈，但薪水会提高？

Teacher:

Exactly. AI replaces the basic version; the human version becomes the luxury version.

没错。AI 取代基础版，真人版变成奢侈版。

► 替换链：repetitive job → AI replaces basic → human shifts to high-end → status symbol

Topic 2: Chasing the Image

话题 2：追逐形象

Young people rent luxury items or go in debt to look wealthy online.

年轻人通过租用奢侈品或负债来在网上显得富有。

Teacher:

What do people use to show their social status nowadays?

现在人们用什么来展示社会地位？

Students:

Watches, cars and houses.

名表、豪车和房子。

Teacher:

Yes. These are all materialistic things. Many young people even go in debt or rent expensive cars just to take photos and pretend to be wealthy.

是的，这些都是物质化的东西。很多年轻人甚至负债或租豪车，就为了拍照假装有钱。

Student:

Being an influencer is also a popular status symbol now.

做网红现在也是一种流行的身份象征。

Teacher:

Right. Traditional status symbols are still common, but digital influence is rising fast.

对。传统身份象征仍然普遍，但数字影响力增长很快。

▶ 不要盲从：go in debt to look rich / rent luxury to post photos 都是不良跟风的警示表达。

Topic 3: Housing Crisis & Generations

话题 3：房价危机与代际

Big cities attract people, demand exceeds supply, prices keep rising. Gen Z and baby boomers often disagree.

大城市吸引人口，需求超过供给，价格持续上涨。Z 世代和婴儿潮一代常常看法不一。

Teacher:

Why are housing prices so high in big cities?

大城市房价为什么这么高？

Student:

Too many people move to big cities.

太多人涌入大城市。

Teacher:

Right. Housing is a limited resource. More people mean fiercer competition, so prices keep rising.

没错。住房是稀缺资源。人越多竞争越激烈，价格就不断上涨。

Teacher:

In Western countries, Gen Z and millennials often disagree with baby boomers.

在西方国家，Z世代和千禧一代常常和婴儿潮一代看法不同。

Student:

Yes, they have misunderstandings about jobs, housing and life pressure.

是的，他们对工作、住房和生活压力都有误解。

Teacher:

Older generations cannot understand today's young people's troubles.

老一辈无法理解当代年轻人的烦恼。

► 高房价诱因：人口涌入 + 资源稀缺 + 竞争激烈 = 价格持续上涨

Topic 4: Marriage & Low Fertility Rate

话题 4：婚恋与低生育率

Matchmaking is common in some cultures. Low birth rate causes labor shortage and pension pressure.

相亲在部分文化中很常见。生育率低导致劳动力短缺和养老压力。

Teacher:

Many parents urge their children to get married early. We can even see parents looking for partners for their kids at People's Square in Shanghai.

很多父母催孩子早点结婚。在上海人民广场甚至能看到父母为孩子公开征婚。

Student:

It actually works sometimes. I saw a news story about it.

有时还真成了。我在新闻上看到过。

Teacher:

Low birth rate is a big problem. It will lead to a shortage of labor force.

低生育率是个大问题。它会导致劳动力短缺。

Student:

To improve this, people need more free time and lower living costs.

要改善这个情况，人们需要更多闲暇时间和更低的生活成本。

► 低生育率链条：低生育率 -> 劳动力短缺 -> 养老负担加重 -> 社会压力增大

Topic 5: Individualism vs Collectivism

话题 5：个人主义 vs 集体主义

Too much individualism causes conflict; too much collectivism kills creativity.

过度个人主义引发冲突；过度集体主义扼杀创造力。

Teacher:

What problems will too much individualism bring?

过度个人主义会带来什么问题？

Student:

People will have different ideas and cause conflicts.

人们会有不同观点，引发冲突。

Teacher:

Correct. Too much individualism breaks teamwork; too much collectivism kills creativity.

没错。太多个人主义破坏团队合作；太多集体主义扼杀创造力。

Student:

So we need to find the sweet spot between the two.

所以我们要找到两者之间的平衡点。

Teacher:

Yes. The ideal is to respect the group while protecting personal expression.

对。理想状态是尊重集体的同时保护个人表达。

► 平衡表达：sweet spot / balance between X and Y / ideal middle ground

Topic 6: Longer Lifespan & Related Issues

话题 6：寿命延长及衍生问题

Better food, healthy lifestyles and advanced medicine extend lifespan. Aging brings new challenges.

更好的饮食、健康的生活方式和先进的医学延长了寿命。老龄化带来新挑战。

Teacher:

People live much longer today because of better food, healthy lifestyles and advanced medicine.

今天的人寿命更长，归功于更好的饮食、健康的生活方式和先进的医学。

Student:

I read that some scientists believe we can copy human brains into computers and live forever in VR.

我看到一些科学家认为我们可以把大脑复制到电脑中，在 VR 中永生。

Teacher:

But most people think the copy is not the real self.

但大多数人认为复制体不是真正的自己。

Student:

Longer life also brings troubles in resource allocation.

更长的寿命也带来资源分配的问题。

Teacher:

Exactly. Aging society tests the pension system and labor market.

没错。老龄化社会考验养老体系和劳动力市场。

► 伦理表达: digital immortality / copy is not the real self / identity in VR

Topic 7: Future Laws & Social Rules

话题 7：未来法律与社会规则

Cloning, privacy, animal protection and labor law will all evolve.

克隆、隐私、动物保护和劳动法都会演变。

Teacher:

Many laws and rules will change in the future.

未来很多法律法规都会改变。

Student:

I suppose people have heated debates on human cloning.

我猜围绕人类克隆会有激烈争论。

Teacher:

Yes. Also, we pay more attention to privacy and animal protection.

是的。我们也会更关注隐私和动物保护。

Student:

Will labor laws be improved to prevent overwork?

劳动法会改进以防止过度加班吗？

Teacher:

Yes, as work-life balance becomes a bigger concern.

会的，因为工作与生活的平衡越来越受重视。

► 未来规则：data privacy / phone-use rules / digital ethics / work-life balance

Topic 8: Technology, Energy & Space

话题 8：科技、能源与星际探索

Tech brings both progress and pollution. Energy and space travel need careful balance.

科技带来进步也带来污染。能源和星际旅行需要谨慎平衡。

Teacher:

Star traveling may come true one day, but it will cost huge resources.

星际旅行可能有一天会成真，但需要巨大资源。

Student:

It's an exciting dream yet needs careful planning.

这是令人兴奋的梦想，但需要仔细规划。

Teacher:

Technology causes pollution. Nuclear power is clean and powerful, but many countries worry about its risks.

科技带来污染。核能清洁高效，但很多国家担心风险。

Student:

So we need to balance development and safety.

所以我们要在发展和安全之间取得平衡。

► 平衡表达：balance development and safety / renewable energy / carbon emissions

Topic 9: AI Romance & Language Learning

话题 9：AI 恋爱与外语学习

AI romance lacks real challenge; foreign languages will become a status symbol.

AI 恋爱缺乏真正的挑战；外语将变成身份象征。

Teacher:

Some people build romantic relationships with AI. AI always satisfies you, but life without challenges cannot bring real happiness.

一些人与 AI 建立恋爱关系。AI 总是满足你，但没有挑战的生活无法带来真正的幸福。

Student:

So challenge is part of what makes life meaningful.

所以挑战是让生活有意义的一部分。

Teacher:

AI can do translation easily, so learning foreign languages will become a new status symbol, just like a form of art that represents one's taste and pursuit.

AI 翻译很轻松，所以学外语会变成新的身份象征，像代表品味和追求的艺术。

Student:

Then creativity, empathy and critical thinking will matter more than ever.

那创造、共情和批判性思维会比以往更重要。

► 未来关键能力：creativity / empathy / critical thinking / artistic perception

Topic 10: Overall Views on the Future

话题 10：对未来的整体看法

Many problems exist, but most people stay optimistic. 'It's always darkest before dawn.'

问题很多，但大多数人保持乐观。“黎明前总是最黑暗的。”

Teacher:

Many of us feel worried about future problems, but most people are optimistic.

我们很多人对未来感到担忧，但大多数人是乐观的。

Student:

There is an old saying: 'It's always darkest before dawn.'

有句老话：“黎明前总是最黑暗的。”

Teacher:

Problems will appear, but we will also find ways to solve them.

问题会出现，但我们也会找到解决方法。

Student:

A bright future means people can find meaning and new goals in life.

光明的未来意味着人们能在生活中找到意义和新的目标。

► 整体观点：opportunity + challenge → 保持探索的热情，在奋斗中寻找价值。

Pronunciation Tips

发音提示

Word Stress

单词重音

- re-PET-i-tive /rɪ'petətɪv/
- com-PET-i-tive /kəm'petətɪv/
- ma-te-ri-al-IS-tic /mə'tɪəriə'lɪstɪk/
- in-di-VID-u-al-ism /,ɪndɪ'vɪdʒuəlɪzəm/
- col-LEC-tiv-ism /kə'lektɪvɪzəm/
- cre-a-TIV-i-ty /,kri:ə'tɪvəti/
- fu-TUR-ism /'fju:tʃərəzəm/
- nu-CLE-ar /'nju:kliə(r)/
- e-co-pro-TEC-tion /,i:kəʊ prə'tekʃn/

Sentence Breaking

句子停顿

- AI never tires, | so translation, driving, | and customer service | are easily replaced.
- Many laws and rules | will change in the future.
- Star traveling | may come true one day, | but it will cost | huge resources.

Linking

连读

- it's_always_darkest_before_dawn → /ɪts 'ɔ:lweɪz ,dɑ:kɪst bɪ'fɔ: dɔ:n/
- an_old_saying → /ən əʊld 'seɪɪŋ/
- balance_development_and_safety → /'bæləns dɪ'veləpmənt ən 'seɪfti/

Guided Practice

引导练习

Exercise 1: Vocabulary Matching

练习 1：词汇匹配

Match each English word with its Chinese meaning.

把英文单词和中文释义配对。

1. (1) repetitive — _____ A. _____
2. (2) status symbol — _____ B. _____
3. (3) fertility rate — _____ C. _____
4. (4) nuclear power — _____ D. _____
5. (5) resource allocation — _____ E. _____

Exercise 2: Topic Comprehension

练习 2：话题理解

Answer each question with one or two full sentences.

用一到两个完整句子回答下列问题。

1. Which jobs does AI replace first, and which jobs get upgraded? _____
2. Why do some young people rent luxury items or go in debt? _____
3. What is the link between housing prices and city population? _____
4. What chain of problems does a low fertility rate cause? _____
5. Why do we need a sweet spot between individualism and collectivism?

6. Why is the digital copy 'not the real self'? _____
7. Which future laws are likely to change the most? _____

8. How do we balance technology and the environment? _____
9. Why will foreign languages become a 'form of art'? _____
10. What is the overall optimistic view on the future? _____

Exercise 3: Sentence Completion

练习 3：句子补全

Complete each sentence with the correct word from the box.

用方框中的词补全句子。

Word Box: repetitive | status symbol | fertility rate | individualism | lifespan | privacy | nuclear power | romantic relationship | challenge | sweet spot

1. Translation and driving are _____ jobs that AI can take over.

2. Watches, cars and houses are still common _____. _____
3. The _____ is dropping in many developed countries. _____
4. Too much _____ causes conflict between people. _____
5. Modern medicine helps extend human _____. _____
6. Data _____ is a major concern in the digital age. _____
7. _____ is clean but its safety is widely debated. _____
8. Some people build a _____ with AI chatbots. _____
9. Life without _____ cannot bring real happiness. _____
10. We need a _____ between rules and personal freedom. _____

Exercise 4: Discussion Prompts

练习 4：讨论题

Discuss with a partner. Use at least 3 of the key vocabulary words in your answer.

和搭档讨论。回答中至少使用 3 个本课词汇。

1. Which future trend worries you the most, and why? _____
2. Do you think AI romance is healthy? Give reasons. _____
3. How can young people afford a house in a big city? _____
4. What does the sweet spot between individualism and collectivism look like in your family? _____
5. If you could live forever in VR, would you? Why or why not? _____

Speaking Task

口语任务

1. Pick one of the 10 topics and give a 2-minute talk using at least 5 key words

从 10 个话题中选一个，做 2 分钟演讲，至少使用 5 个核心词汇

2. Debate: 'AI brings more good than harm to future jobs' (2 vs 2)

辩论：“AI 对未来工作的好处多于坏处”（2 对 2 辩论）

3. Role-play: an interview with a baby boomer and a Gen Z on housing prices

角色扮演：婴儿潮一代与 Z 世代就房价问题进行采访对话

4. Group discussion: pick 2 future laws to change first, and explain why

小组讨论：选出 2 条最该先改的法规，并说明理由

Review

复盘总结

Key Takeaways

要点回顾

- AI replaces repetitive jobs first; some roles shift to high-end, status-symbol services

AI 优先取代重复性工作；部分岗位升级为高端、身份象征型服务

- Traditional status symbols (watches, cars, houses) coexist with new digital ones (influencers, rented luxury)

传统身份象征（名表/豪车/房产）与新兴数字身份（网红/租借奢侈品）并存

- Housing crisis: limited resource + city migration + fierce competition = rising prices

房价危机：资源稀缺 + 人口涌入 + 激烈竞争 = 价格上涨

- Low fertility rate leads to labor shortage and pension burden; needs more free time and lower living costs

低生育率导致劳动力短缺和养老负担；需要更多闲暇和更低生活成本

- Too much individualism causes conflict; too much collectivism kills creativity — find a sweet spot

过度个人主义引发冲突；过度集体主义扼杀创造力——需要平衡点

- Longer lifespan comes from food, healthy habits and medical development; aging tests resource allocation

寿命延长源于饮食、健康习惯和医疗进步；老龄化考验资源分配

- Future laws will evolve around cloning, privacy, animal protection, and labor rights

未来法律将围绕克隆、隐私、动物保护和劳动权益演变

- Technology brings progress and pollution; balance development and safety in energy and space

科技带来进步和污染；能源与太空要在发展和安全间取得平衡

- AI romance lacks real challenges; foreign languages will become a status symbol / form of art

AI 恋爱缺乏真正挑战；外语将变成身份象征和艺术形式

- Stay optimistic: 'It's always darkest before dawn.' Find meaning and new goals.

保持乐观：“黎明前总是最黑暗的”。寻找意义和新的目标。

Self-Check

自检

1. Can you list 3 jobs that AI will replace and 3 that will be upgraded?

你能列出 3 个 AI 会取代的工作和 3 个会升级的工作吗？

2. Explain the chain: low fertility rate -> labor shortage -> pension burden

请解释链条：低生育率 -> 劳动力短缺 -> 养老负担

3. Why is the digital copy 'not the real self'?

为什么数字复制体“不是真正的自己”？

4. What's the sweet spot between individualism and collectivism in your life?

在你的生活中，个人主义和集体主义的平衡点是什么？

Topic Summary Table

话题总结表

Topic	Key Idea	
01 AI & Jobs	Repetitive jobs replaced; some upgraded to luxury	repetitive / competitive / service
02 Status Symbols	Watches, cars, houses + influencers + rented luxury	status symbol / materialistic / rent
03 Housing	Limited resource + migration = rising prices	housing price / generation / misunderstanding
04 Marriage & Fertility	Matchmaking + low birth rate = labor shortage	marriage / fertility rate / free time
05 Individual vs Collective	Find sweet spot between freedom and group	individualism / collectivism / sweet spot
06 Lifespan	Better food + habits + medicine; aging = resource test	lifespan / medical development / VR
07 Future Laws	Cloning / privacy / animal / labor law evolve	clone / privacy / labor law / illegal
08 Tech & Space	Progress needs balance: energy, environment, space	nuclear power / pollution / star traveling
09 AI Romance & Language	AI love lacks challenge; language becomes art	romantic relationship / challenge / art
10 Overall View	Stay optimistic: darkest before dawn	meaning / goal / future

Homework

课后练习

1. Writing

写作练习

Choose 3 of the 10 topics. For each, write a short paragraph (60-80 words) using at least 3 key words.

从 10 个话题中选 3 个，每个写一段 60-80 词的短文，至少使用 3 个核心词汇。

1. Topic 1: _____

2. Topic 2: _____

3. Topic 3: _____

2. Vocabulary Review

词汇复习

Write a sentence for each of these 6 key words: repetitive, status symbol, fertility rate, individualism, lifespan, nuclear power

用以下 6 个关键词各造一个句子：repetitive, status symbol, fertility rate, individualism, lifespan, nuclear power

1. repetitive: _____

2. status symbol: _____

3. fertility rate: _____

4. individualism: _____

5. lifespan: _____

6. nuclear power: _____

3. Listening Practice

听力练习

Find a 3-minute English video or podcast about AI, technology, or future society. Note down 5 new expressions you hear.

找一段 3 分钟关于 AI / 科技 / 未来的英语视频或播客，记下 5 个新表达。

1. Expression: _____

2. Expression: _____

3. Expression: _____

4. Expression: _____

5. Expression: _____

Appendix: Classroom Grammar Correction

附录：课堂语法纠错（Speaker 3 & 4）

This section collects real classroom sentences from Speaker 3 and Speaker 4 with teacher corrections. Use it to avoid common errors in your own speaking.

本节收集了 Speaker 3 和 Speaker 4 在课堂上的真实句子，并附老师的纠错。避免在自己的口语中出现类似错误。

Speaker 3: Build Complete Structure

Speaker 3: 补全结构，丰富表达

Original

原句

No creation. / The country will disappear.

Correction

修正

It will lead to a lack of creativity... / face great challenges and even decline.

Why

解析

Avoid single-word answers. Complete the subject-verb structure for clearer statements. Use 'creativity' instead of 'creation' for accuracy, and avoid extreme words like 'disappear'.

Speaker 4: Precise Word Choice, Cleaner Sentences

Speaker 4: 精准用词，优化句式

Original

原句

Low low birth rate, low birth rate, yeah. / Make everything get low price. / more cheaper.

Correction

修正

Low birth rate is a serious problem. / We can cut living costs and lower housing prices. / cheaper.

Why

解析

Fix repetition and word-order mistakes. Use natural collocations like 'cut living costs'. Remember: do not stack 'more' with comparative 'cheaper' (it must be one or the other).

Bonus: Complete-the-Sentence (Speaker 3)

拓展：完成句子（Speaker 3）

Original

原句

Star traveling. / I think so, better.

Correction

修正

I think star traveling will become a reality... / I also believe the future will become better.

Why

解析

Expand short phrases into full sentences. Use the fixed phrase 'become a reality' for natural flow.

Speaking Tips

口语提升小贴士

- Prefer full sentences over single words or phrases

优先完整句：拒绝单词/短语作答，用简单句清晰表达观点

- Watch for grammar traps: never stack 'more' with '-er' comparatives

警惕语法错误：形容词比较级（如 cheaper）不可叠加 more

- Distinguish 'creativity' from 'creation'

区分 creativity 与 creation

- Cut filler words (like, maybe, yeah) for cleaner delivery

精简口头语：减少 like / maybe / yeah 等填充词

Answer Key

参考答案

Exercise 1: Vocabulary Matching

1. C 2. A 3. B 4. E 5. D

Exercise 2: Topic Comprehension (sample answers)

1. AI first replaces repetitive jobs like translation, driving, and customer service. Some roles (e.g., personal drivers) get upgraded into high-end, status-symbol services.
2. They want to look wealthy on social media. Going in debt or renting luxury items gives a quick image boost.
3. Big cities attract a lot of people, but housing is a limited resource. More demand and limited supply push prices up.
4. A low fertility rate means fewer babies are born. In 20 years, the labor force shrinks, and there are not enough workers to support the pension system.
5. Pure individualism breaks teamwork, while pure collectivism kills creativity. A sweet spot respects both the group and the individual.
6. A digital copy only stores patterns or memories. It does not have consciousness or lived experience, so it is not the real self.
7. Laws on cloning, data privacy, animal protection, and labor rights will change the most.
8. We need clean energy, lower pollution, and careful planning. Progress must be paired with environmental awareness and risk management.
9. When AI handles basic translation, knowing a foreign language is no longer just a job skill. It becomes a sign of taste, culture, and personal style — like a form of art.
10. Problems will come, but humans keep finding solutions. A bright future means we can find meaning and new goals in life.

Exercise 3: Sentence Completion

1. repetitive 2. status symbol 3. fertility rate 4. individualism 5. lifespan
6. privacy 7. Nuclear power 8. romantic relationship 9. challenges 10. sweet spot

Exercise 4: Discussion Prompts (sample answers)

1. I worry most about AI replacing repetitive jobs, because many workers may need to retrain quickly.
2. I do not think AI romance is healthy. It always agrees with you, so you cannot grow from real disagreements.
3. Young people can buy in smaller cities, share housing, or save for a long time before buying in a big city.
4. In my family, we respect each person's choice, but we also keep some shared family rules — that is our sweet spot.
5. I would not. Life in VR may feel endless, but I want to stay connected to real people and real challenges.

Homework Vocabulary Review (sample sentences)

1. repetitive: Data entry is a repetitive job that AI can do well.
2. status symbol: A house used to be a clear status symbol in China.
3. fertility rate: The fertility rate in many countries is below 1.5 now.
4. individualism: Modern cities often celebrate individualism and personal success.
5. lifespan: A balanced diet and exercise can extend lifespan.
6. nuclear power: Some countries use nuclear power to reduce carbon emissions.